



Percentages

A PERCENTAGE SHOWS AN AMOUNT AS A PART OF 100.

Any number can be written as a part of 100 or a percentage. Percent means “per hundred,” and it is a useful way of comparing two or more quantities. The symbol “%” is used to indicate a percentage.

SEE ALSO

◀ 44–45 Decimals

◀ 48–55 Fractions

Ratio and proportion 56–59 ▶

Rounding off 70–71 ▶

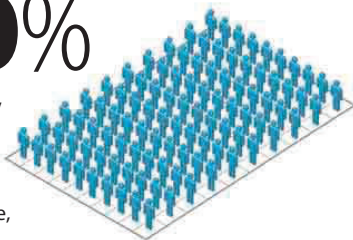
Parts of 100

The simplest way to start looking at percentages is by dealing with a block of 100 units, as shown in the main image. These 100 units represent the total number of people in a school. This total can be divided into different groups according to the proportion of the total 100 they represent.

100%

▷ This is simply

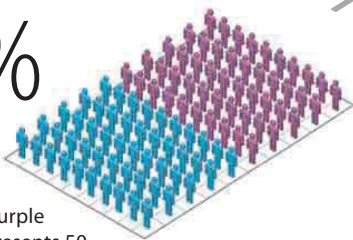
another way of saying “everybody” or “everything.” Here, all 100 figures —100%—are blue.



50%

▷ This group

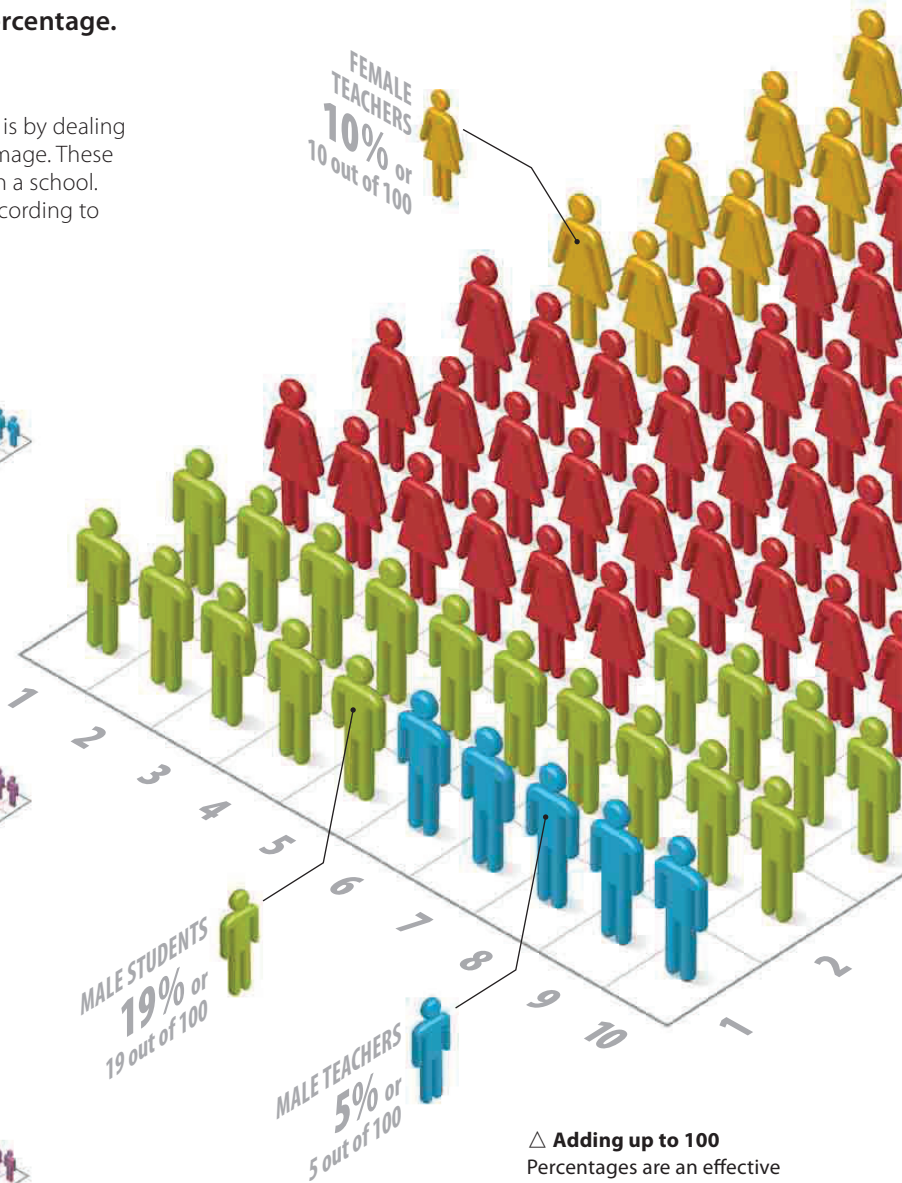
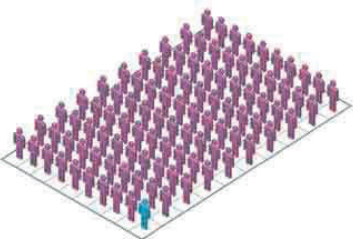
is equally divided between 50 blue and 50 purple figures. Each represents 50 out of 100 or 50% of the total. This is the same as half.



1%

▷ In this group

there is only 1 blue figure out of 100, or 1%.



△ Adding up to 100

Percentages are an effective way to show the component parts of a total. For example, male teachers (blue) account for 5% (5 out of 100) of the total.